走出苏联的俄罗斯方块

The Game That Escaped the Soviet Union



游戏风靡世界后，为什么作者多年未分到游戏收益？

READ 纯净阅读

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RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In June 1984 Alexey Pajitnov, a 29-year-old Moscow coder, grew engrossed in a diversion he had built. His primitive Elektronika 60 had a purely textual display, so every geometric piece of four tiles was assembled from characters. The result proved addictive. He called it Tetris, a fusion of the Greek tetra- and tennis, his favourite pastime.

In the Soviet Union, the state, not its salaried designer, was the proprietor of this intellectual property, and Pajitnov held no entitlement to it. Copies mushroomed freely on floppy disks across the Eastern bloc.

In 1986 Robert Stein, an enterprising British software vendor, stumbled upon Tetris in Hungary. In his ignorance of Elorg, the state bureau regulating Soviet software exports, he hastily hawked rights he did not yet legitimately hold. The rights were shuffled onward through a chaotic muddle of overlapping deals among Western firms, one owned by the magnate Robert Maxwell.

In February 1989 Henk Rogers, a resourceful Dutch-born publisher, reached Moscow on a tourist visa and found his way to Elorg. Stein and Kevin Maxwell, the magnate's son, were in Moscow that same hectic week of negotiations, each a bidder. Pajitnov felt a fondness for Rogers, and Nintendo scooped the handheld rights, then worldwide console rights.

Nintendo bundled Tetris with its pocket-sized Game Boy, and that version shipped over 35 million copies. Pajitnov reaped none of the spoils for years. His earnings began only after his arrangement's expiry around 1995. In 1996 he and Rogers founded The Tetris Company to manage the rights.

The man whose puzzle once spread for nothing later helped decide who could sell it.

中文译文

1984年6月，29岁的莫斯科程序员阿列克谢·帕基特诺夫，沉迷于自己编写的一款小游戏。他那台简陋的Elektronika 60电脑只能显示文字，于是每个由四个小格构成的几何块，都用字符拼成。游戏让人欲罢不能。他把希腊语前缀tetra-与自己最爱的消遣——网球的英文tennis——结合起来，给它取名Tetris，也就是俄罗斯方块。

在苏联，这项知识产权归国家所有，并不属于领取工资的设计者，帕基特诺夫没有支配它的权利。游戏复制品通过软盘，在东欧集团各地自由传播、迅速增多。

1986年，富有进取心的英国软件商罗伯特·斯坦因在匈牙利偶然发现俄罗斯方块。他不知道Elorg是监管苏联软件出口的国家机构，尚未合法取得权利，便草率地兜售版权。权利在西方公司之间不断转手，各种相互重叠的交易混成一团；其中一家公司属于大亨罗伯特·马克斯韦尔。

1989年2月，出生于荷兰、足智多谋的发行商亨克·罗杰斯持旅游签证来到莫斯科，设法找到Elorg。同一个忙乱的谈判周里，斯坦因与大亨之子凯文·马克斯韦尔也在莫斯科，分别参与竞标。帕基特诺夫对罗杰斯颇有好感。任天堂最终抢得掌机版权，随后又拿到全球游戏主机版权。

任天堂把俄罗斯方块与口袋大小的Game Boy捆绑销售，这个版本出货超过3500万份。帕基特诺夫多年未能分享游戏带来的商业收益；直到原有协议于1995年前后到期，才开始从游戏中获得收益。1996年，他与罗杰斯创办俄罗斯方块公司，管理相关权利。

当年，他的益智游戏曾免费流传；后来，他也参与决定谁可以出售它。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

engrossed in 形容词短语
全神贯注于；沉迷于
grew engrossed in a diversion

textual adj.
文字的；文本的
a purely textual display

be assembled from 动词短语
由……拼成
assembled from characters

fusion n.
融合
a fusion of the Greek tetra-

proprietor n.
所有者
the proprietor

intellectual property 名词短语
知识产权
this intellectual property

entitlement n.
拥有某物的权利
held no entitlement to it

mushroom v.
迅速增多
Copies mushroomed freely

enterprising adj.
富有进取心的
enterprising British software vendor

vendor n.
销售商
enterprising British software vendor

stumble upon 动词短语
偶然发现
stumbled upon Tetris in Hungary

regulate v.
监管
regulating Soviet software exports

legitimately adv.
合法地
did not yet legitimately hold

overlap v.（分词作定语）
相互重叠
overlapping deals among Western firms

resourceful adj.
足智多谋的
a resourceful Dutch-born publisher

negotiation n.
谈判
hectic week of negotiations

bidder n.
竞标者
each a bidder

bundle v.
捆绑销售
Nintendo bundled Tetris

reap v.
收获；获得
reaped none of the spoils

earnings n.
收入；此处指游戏收益
His earnings began only after

arrangement n.
协议；安排
his arrangement's expiry

expiry n.
到期
his arrangement's expiry around 1995

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共43项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

Moscow 专名
莫斯科

coder n.
程序员

diversion n.
消遣；游戏

primitive adj.
简陋的

purely adv.
完全地；纯粹地

geometric adj.
几何的

tile n.
小格；方块

character n.
字符

addictive adj.
让人上瘾的

Tetris 专名
俄罗斯方块

Greek adj.
希腊语的

pastime n.
消遣

salaried adj.
领取工资的

designer n.
设计者

freely adv.
自由地；不受限制地

floppy disk 名词短语
软盘

Eastern bloc 专名
东欧集团

software n.
软件

Hungary 专名
匈牙利

in prep.
处于；与ignorance of连用

ignorance n.
不知情；缺乏了解

of prep.
对；引出不了解的对象

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共43项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

state bureau 名词短语
国家机构

hastily adv.
草率地；仓促地

hawk v.
兜售

shuffle v.
不断倒手；来回转移

onward adv.
继续向前；此处指继续转手

chaotic adj.
混乱的

muddle n.
混乱局面

magnate n.
商业大亨

publisher n.
发行商

visa n.
签证

find one's way to 动词短语
设法找到；来到

hectic adj.
忙乱的

fondness n.
好感；喜爱

Nintendo 专名
任天堂

scoop v.
抢先获得

console n.
游戏主机

pocket-sized adj.
口袋大小的

version n.
版本

spoils n.
获利；收益

found v.
创办

puzzle n.
益智游戏

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 the state, not its salaried designer, was the proprietor of this _____

02 Copies _____ freely on floppy disks across the Eastern bloc.

03 Nintendo _____ Tetris with its pocket-sized Game Boy

04 His earnings began only after his arrangement's _____ around 1995.

文章主线

- 诞生 1984年，苏联程序员帕基特诺夫在只能显示文字的电脑上，用字符做出了俄罗斯方块。
- 归属 游戏版权属于苏联国家，作者没有支配权，复制品则通过软盘在东欧集团迅速流传。
- 混战 英国软件商斯坦因不知Elorg掌管苏联软件出口，未获授权就转卖版权，造成西方公司权利重叠。
- 突破 1989年，发行商罗杰斯找到Elorg谈判，任天堂获掌机及全球主机版权，Game Boy版出货3500多万份。
- 获益 帕基特诺夫到约1995年旧协议到期才开始获得游戏收益；1996年与罗杰斯成立公司，参与管理版权。

参考答案　1 intellectual property 2 mushroomed 3 bundled 4 expiry